A FIELD GUIDE TO WHAT WE OFFER

Know Your Products

Eight products, four jobs. Each entry explains one product the same way: what it is, how it works, who it suits and what to ask before you sign. Write your own numbers in the spaces provided and your finances stay in one place all year.

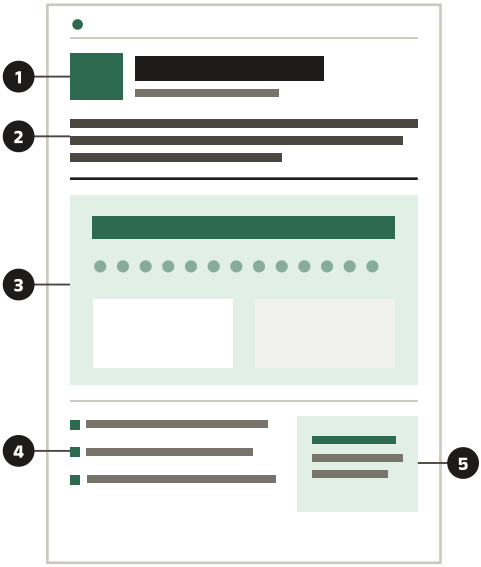
PROTECT | BUILD | SPECIALISE | GLOBALISE

PROTECT	01	**Term Insurance**	4
	02	**Health Insurance**	6
BUILD	03	**Mutual Funds**	8
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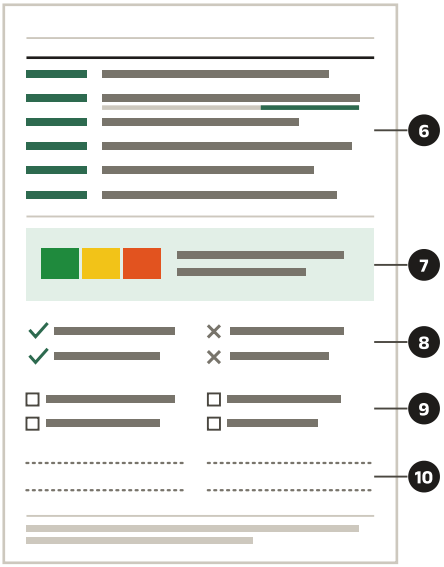
Facts are as of October 2026. Rules change, so check the latest with us before you invest. This section is investor education. It is not advice, and not an offer to buy or sell any product.

How to read an entry

Every product gets the same two pages, laid out the same way, so you can compare one with another. The left page helps you **recognise** the product. The right page helps you **decide** whether it fits.



LEFT PAGE: RECOGNISE IT



RIGHT PAGE: DECIDE IF IT FITS

1. **Job colour and number**
   Green protects, indigo builds, jamun specialises, turmeric globalises.

2. **In one line**
   The product in plain words.

3. **How it works**
   One picture of the mechanism, usually with a worked example.

4. **How to recognise it**
   The features that set it apart.

5. **Often confused with**
   The look-alike, and the difference.

6. **At a glance**
   The same six facts for every product. A ruler shows the minimum on one scale, ₹100 to ₹1 crore.

7. **The check that matters most**
   The regulator's own scale where one exists: riskometer, risk band or credit rating.

8. **Suits you if, think twice if**
   Who the product is for, and who it is not for.

9. **Ask before you sign**
   Questions to put to us or the provider. Tick them off.

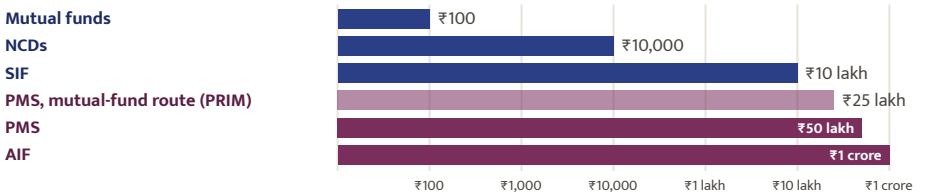
10. **My notes**
    Space for your own numbers, so they stay with the explanation.

Four jobs your money can do

Read from left to right. Each job works best once the one before it is in place: protection before investing, and a core portfolio before specialist strategies.

1 · PROTECT	2 · BUILD	3 · SPECIALISE	4 · GLOBALISE
If something happens to me, is my family covered?	How do I grow wealth and earn an income?	My portfolio is large. What more can I do?	How do I invest beyond India?
01 **Term insurance** priced by premium	03 **Mutual funds** from ₹100	06 **PMS** from ₹50 lakh	08 **GIFT City** in US dollars, via LRS
02 **Health insurance** priced by premium	04 **SIF** from ₹10 lakh	07 **AIF** from ₹1 crore	
	05 **NCDs** from ₹10,000		
START Before you invest.	**START** Once your family is protected.	**START** When a core portfolio is in place.	**START** To spread risk beyond one country.

MINIMUM TO START, ON ONE SCALE — EACH GRIDLINE IS TEN TIMES THE LAST



BEFORE YOU MOVE RIGHT — Tick what is already in place

- ☐ Term cover that matches your family's needs, often 10 to 15 times yearly income
- ☐ An emergency fund of about six months' expenses, easy to reach
- ☐ Health cover for every member of your family, not only through an employer
- ☐ A core portfolio in mutual funds or SIFs, linked to your goals

PRIM is the mutual-fund-only PMS route that starts on 1 April 2027. Insurance is priced by premium and GIFT City minimums are in US dollars, so neither is on the scale above.

01 Term Insurance

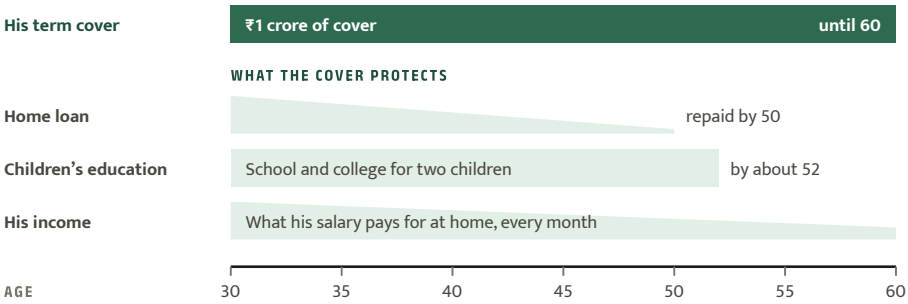
PURE LIFE COVER FOR YOUR FAMILY · REGULATED BY IRDAI

Term insurance keeps your family's plans on track if you are not there to provide for them. You pay a premium each year, and if something happens to you during the term, your family receives the full cover amount.

HOW IT PROTECTS A FAMILY

FIG. 01

Example. Rohan, 30, with young children and a home loan, takes ₹1 crore of cover.



Each need gets smaller as the years pass. The term is chosen to last while the family relies on his income.

IF SOMETHING HAPPENS TO ROHAN

₹1 crore

goes to his family to clear the home loan, keep the children's education on track and replace his income.

WHEN ROHAN TURNS 60

Job done

The cover ends. The loan is repaid, the children are independent, and paying only for protection kept the premium low.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- Replaces your income for your family, so loans, school fees and monthly expenses stay covered.
- The premium is fixed when you buy and usually stays the same for the whole term.
- Your family can receive the amount at once, as a monthly income, or both, as you choose.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

Return-of-premium and endowment plans. They give money back at the end, but cost much more for the same cover. Some term plans offer a 'special exit' instead: stop at a set age and get your base premiums back.

AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	IRDAI
WHAT YOU PAY	A premium, yearly or monthly, fixed when you buy. It depends on your age, health, habits, cover and term.
TIME COMMITMENT	The term you choose, usually until your earning years end (age 60–70). You get 30 days to return a new policy (free look).
WHEN IT PAYS	To your family (your nominee) if something happens to you during the term. IRDAI allows 15 days to settle a claim, or 45 if it needs investigation.
COSTS	Only the premium. No GST on individual policies since 22 September 2025.
TAX IN BRIEF	Old regime: premium deductible under Sec. 123 (earlier 80C). The amount your family receives is tax-free.

WORK OUT YOUR COVER

Rule of thumb: 10 to 15 times yearly income

A	Yearly household expenses	₹	D	+ Loans still to repay	₹
B	× Years your family needs support		E	+ Big goals: education, marriage	₹
C	= Income to replace (A × B)	₹	F	− Savings and existing cover	₹

Cover you need = C + D + E − F ₹

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ Your family depends on your income, now or in the years ahead.
- ✓ You have a home loan or other commitments your family would carry.
- ✓ You want the largest cover for the lowest premium.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ No one depends on your income and you have no loans.
- ✗ You want money back at the end. That is a savings goal; keep it separate.
- ✗ You are not ready to share your full health details. Honest disclosure keeps claims smooth.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ Is the cover enough for my family's plans, including my loans?
- ☐ Who is my nominee, and does my family know about this policy?
- ☐ Have I shared every health detail, habit and existing policy?
- ☐ What is the insurer's claim settlement record?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

INSURER ..... COVER ₹ .....

PREMIUM DUE ..... NOMINEE .....

Insurance is underwritten by the insurer. Ram Investments is [IRDAI registration type and number]. For details on risk factors, terms and conditions, read the sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale.

02 Health Insurance

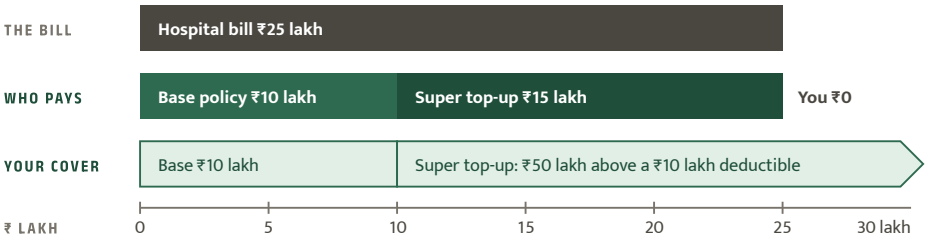
HOSPITAL COVER FOR YOUR FAMILY · REGULATED BY IRDAI

You pay a premium every year. If you need hospital treatment, the insurer pays the bills up to your sum insured, directly to the hospital (cashless) or by repaying you, so the focus stays on getting better.

HOW A BIG BILL GETS PAID

FIG. 02

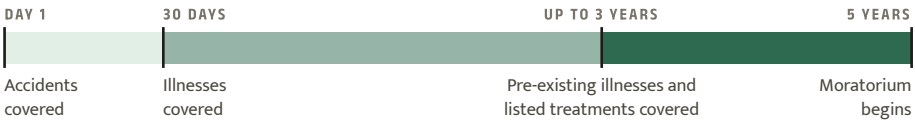
Example. A ₹25 lakh bill, with a ₹10 lakh policy and a super top-up.



A super top-up pays once the year's bills cross its deductible: a low-cost way to raise your cover.

WHEN COVER STARTS, FROM THE DAY YOU BUY

NOT TO SCALE



Moratorium: after 5 continuous years, a claim cannot be refused for non-disclosure, except in fraud.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- Pays actual hospital bills up to the sum insured, for one person or the whole family (floater).
- Claim-free years can raise your cover (no-claim bonus). Some policies refill cover used up in a year (restoration).
- You can move to another insurer without losing waiting-period credit (portability).

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

Critical illness cover. Pays a fixed lump sum when a listed illness is diagnosed, whatever the bill. It adds to health insurance; it does not replace it.

Employer cover. Usually ends when you change jobs or retire.

AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	IRDAI
WHAT YOU PAY	A yearly premium based on age, sum insured, city and health history. No upper age limit to buy since April 2024; insurers still assess each applicant.
TIME COMMITMENT	One year at a time. Renew without a break to keep waiting-period credit and bonus.
WHEN IT PAYS	Cashless at network hospitals (the insurer must decide within 1 hour of a request, and approve discharge within 3 hours), or by reimbursement.
COSTS	Only the premium. No GST on individual policies since 22 September 2025.
TAX IN BRIEF	Old regime: premium deductible under Sec. 126 (earlier 80D), up to ₹25,000 (₹50,000 for senior citizens), plus a separate limit for parents.

READ THE FINE PRINT

Compare before you buy

TERM	LOOK FOR	WATCH OUT FOR
Room rent	No cap, or any single private room	A daily cap. Go above it and the whole bill can be cut in proportion.
Co-payment	None	You pay a fixed share of every claim
Sub-limits	None	Caps on treatments such as cataract or knee surgery
Restoration	Cover refills if used up in a year	No refill
Waiting periods	Short, or reducible with an add-on	The full 3 years for conditions you already have

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ A large hospital bill would eat into your savings.
- ✓ Your only cover today comes from your employer.
- ✓ You have parents or senior family members to look after.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ You are buying mainly for the tax deduction.
- ✗ You have not checked the room-rent cap, co-payment and sub-limits.
- ✗ You plan to let a policy lapse to switch insurers. Port it instead.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ Is there a room-rent cap or a co-payment?
- ☐ Which hospitals near me offer cashless treatment?
- ☐ Which of my conditions have a waiting period, and how long is it?
- ☐ Is the sum insured enough for hospital costs in my city?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

INSURER ..... SUM INSURED ₹ .....

RENEWAL DATE ..... CLAIMS HELPLINE .....

Insurance is underwritten by the insurer. Ram Investments is [IRDAI registration type and number]. For details on risk factors, terms and conditions, read the sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale.

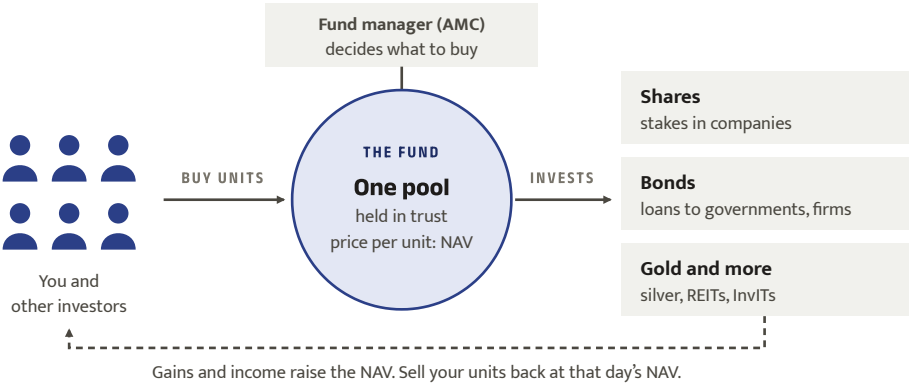
03 Mutual Funds

POOLED, PROFESSIONALLY MANAGED · REGULATED BY SEBI

Many investors pool their money. A professional fund manager invests it in shares, bonds, gold or other assets, as the scheme's rules allow. You own units of the pool, and their value (the NAV) is published every business day.

HOW IT WORKS

FIG. 03



SAFEGUARDS SEBI regulates · trustees oversee the AMC · a custodian holds the assets

FIVE GROUPS OF SCHEMES (SEBI, 2026)

Equity	Debt	Hybrid	Life Cycle	Other
Mainly shares. Long-term growth.	Bonds and money market.	A mix of equity, debt and more.	Moves to debt as a goal nears. NEW IN 2026	Index funds, ETFs, FoFs.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- You own units of a pool, not the shares or bonds themselves.
- Every scheme has a Direct plan and a Regular plan. A Regular plan includes the distributor's commission.
- Schemes must stay true to their label: a large-cap fund, for example, keeps at least 80% in large companies.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

SIF. Run by mutual fund houses with the same tax rules, plus tools for falling and sideways markets. Read it next: entry 04.

ULIP. An insurance policy with an investment part, regulated by IRDAI. It is not a mutual fund.

AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	SEBI. AMFI is the industry body.
MINIMUM	Set by each scheme. SIPs often start at ₹100–₹500 a month.
TIME COMMITMENT	None for most open-ended funds. Tax-saving ELSS funds lock in for 3 years. Equity funds suit goals 5+ years away.
MONEY OUT	Sell units any business day. An exit load may apply if you leave early.
COSTS	The total expense ratio (TER), taken daily from the NAV and capped by SEBI.
TAX IN BRIEF	Equity funds: 12.5% on long-term gains (held over 12 months) above ₹1.25 lakh a year; 20% if short-term. Debt funds: your slab rate.



RISK CHECK: THE RISKOMETER

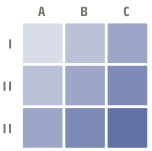
Printed on every scheme



RISKOMETER

1 Low e.g. overnight funds
2 Low to Moderate e.g. liquid funds
3 Moderate
4 Moderately High
5 High
6 Very High most equity funds

DEBT FUNDS: PRC GRID



credit risk (A–C) × rate risk (I–III)

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ You are starting out, or want a core portfolio for long-term goals.
- ✓ You want diversification and professional management with small amounts.
- ✓ You like investing a fixed amount every month (SIP).

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ You need guaranteed returns or capital protection.
- ✗ You may need the money within a year. Equity funds can fall sharply.
- ✗ You are picking a fund on last year's return alone.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ What is the riskometer level, and does it match my comfort?
- ☐ How does this fund fit with what I already own?
- ☐ What are the expense ratio and the exit load?
- ☐ Direct or Regular plan: what am I paying for, and what do I get?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

SIPS RUNNING ..... MONTHLY TOTAL ₹ .....

GOAL AND YEAR ..... REVIEW MONTH .....

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully. Ram Investments is an AMFI Registered Mutual Fund Distributor (ARN-[___]).

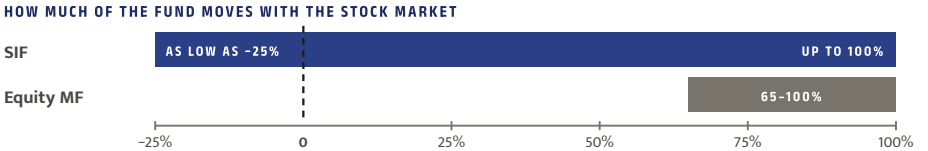
04 SIF

SPECIALISED INVESTMENT FUNDS · REGULATED BY SEBI

A SIF is a mutual fund with a bigger toolkit. It is run by a mutual fund house under SEBI's mutual fund rules and taxed the same way, but the manager can also bet on falls, move between asset classes, and turn market exposure up or down.

ONE FUND, THREE KINDS OF MARKET

FIG. 04



WHEN MARKETS FALL



- Cut exposure, even below zero
- Bet on falls with derivatives, up to 25% of the fund
- Hedge holdings with futures and options

WHEN MARKETS DRIFT



- Earn from price gaps between cash and futures (arbitrage)
- Collect option premiums (covered calls)
- Earn interest on the debt portion

WHEN MARKETS RISE



- Raise exposure, up to 100% of the fund
- Back the sectors and stocks expected to lead
- Lift hedges and shorts to keep the upside

The difference: only a SIF can bet on falls.

An equity mutual fund must stay mostly invested. It can hedge, but cannot bet on falls. A SIF can, with up to 25% of the fund, and total exposure of no more than 100% of the fund, so no borrowing.

Range shown for equity long-short strategies; −25% is the floor some funds state. What the rules allow, not a promise of returns.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- Built for rising, falling and sideways markets: the manager can raise or cut exposure, and bet on falls for up to 25% of the fund.
- Taxed like a mutual fund: no tax inside the fund, only when you redeem.
- Can be conservative or adventurous, from arbitrage-and-debt strategies to equity long-short. The Risk Band (Level 1 to 5) tells you which.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

Mutual funds. Same family, same tax rules. A SIF adds tools for falling and sideways markets, and starts at ₹10 lakh.

Category III AIFs and PMS. Similar long-short tools, but taxed every year. A SIF defers tax until you redeem. More on the next spread.

AT A GLANCE

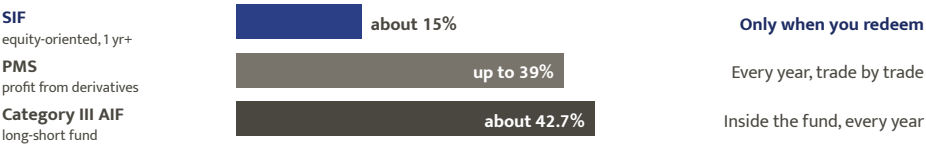
The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	SEBI, under the mutual fund regulations, through eligible fund houses.
MINIMUM	₹10 lakh per investor, across one fund house's SIF strategies.
TIME COMMITMENT	No lock-in for most strategies. Some are interval or close-ended.
MONEY OUT	Equity strategies usually any business day. Hybrid strategies on set days (at least twice a week), with up to 15 working days' notice.
COSTS	An expense ratio taken from the NAV, as with mutual funds.
TAX IN BRIEF	Same as mutual funds. Equity-oriented strategies: 12.5% on long-term gains above ₹1.25 lakh (after 12 months), 20% if sooner.



TAX CHECK: WHY THE WRAPPER MATTERS

Highest tax bracket, illustration



Highest bracket, with surcharge and cess. SIF: 12.5% on long-term gains above ₹1.25 lakh a year (20% within a year). PMS: share sales are taxed as capital gains, derivative profits as business income at your slab. AIF: taxed in the fund at the maximum marginal rate. FY 2026-27 rules.

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ You invest in mutual funds and want strategies that can also manage falls and flat markets.
- ✓ You want one fund that can be a complete portfolio, or its steadier part.
- ✓ You prefer mutual-fund tax treatment to AIF or PMS taxation.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ ₹10 lakh would be most of your investable money.
- ✗ You must be able to withdraw on any day without notice.
- ✗ You expect gains every month. These strategies manage risk; they cannot remove it.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ Which strategy is this, and what is its Risk Band today?
- ☐ Is it equity-oriented for tax, and how often can I redeem?
- ☐ How does the manager change exposure as markets rise, fall or drift?
- ☐ What are the total costs?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

SIF / STRATEGY

AMOUNT ₹

RISK BAND

REDEMPTION DAYS

Investments in SIFs are subject to market risks, read all investment strategy related documents carefully. Ram Investments is an AMFI Registered Mutual Fund Distributor and SIF Distributor (ARN-[___]).

SIF IN DEPTH

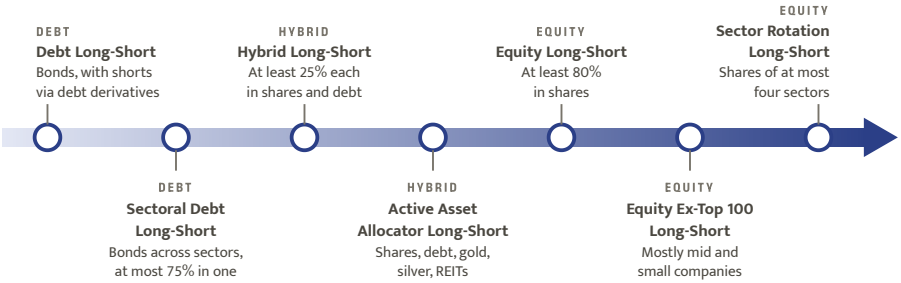
Borrowed abilities, mutual fund rules

A SIF takes tools that used to sit only in hedge-fund-style AIFs and portfolio management services, and keeps the mutual fund's structure, daily NAV and tax treatment.

WHAT THE MANAGER CAN DO	MUTUAL FUND	SIF	PMS	CAT III AIF
Buy shares and bonds	● Yes	● **Yes**	● Yes	● Yes
Bet on falls (unhedged shorts)	○ No	● **Up to 25%**	◐ Limited	● Yes
Move across shares, bonds, gold, silver, REITs	◐ Within its category	● **Yes**	◐ Partly	● Yes
Borrow to invest (leverage)	○ No	○ **No**	○ No	● Up to 2× NAV
Daily price and full disclosure	● Yes	● **Yes**	● Own account	◐ Periodic
No tax inside the fund; tax only when you exit	● Yes	● **Yes**	○ Taxed per trade	○ Taxed in fund
Minimum	₹100	**₹10 lakh**	₹50 lakh	₹1 crore

No borrowing is a safeguard: a SIF's total exposure cannot exceed 100% of the fund.

SEVEN STRATEGIES, CONSERVATIVE TO ADVENTUROUS — Typical position by mandate



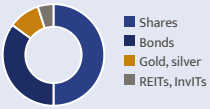
A SIF is a structure, not a risk level. Each strategy discloses its Risk Band (Level 1 to 5) every month; read that, not just the name.

SIF IN DEPTH

Using SIFs in your portfolio

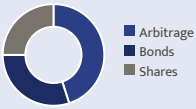
THREE WAYS TO USE A SIF

Mixes shown are examples



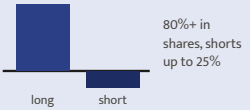
As your whole portfolio

No mutual funds yet? An asset allocator strategy can hold shares, bonds, gold, silver and REITs in one fund, and shift between them.



As the conservative part

Hybrid and debt strategies can keep most money in arbitrage and bonds, with a small share in stocks, aiming for smaller swings than equity funds.

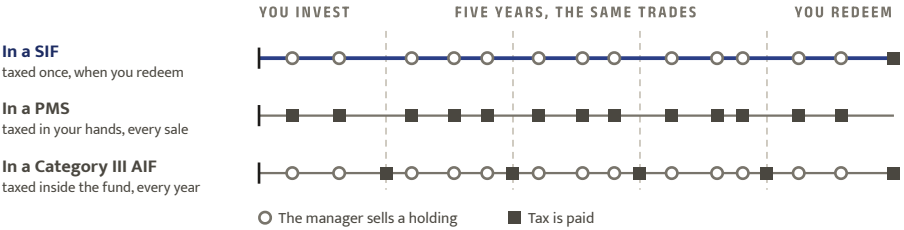


As the equity part

Equity long-short strategies can sit beside your equity funds, and can hedge or cut exposure when markets turn.

TAX IN PRACTICE: WHEN THE TAX IS PAID

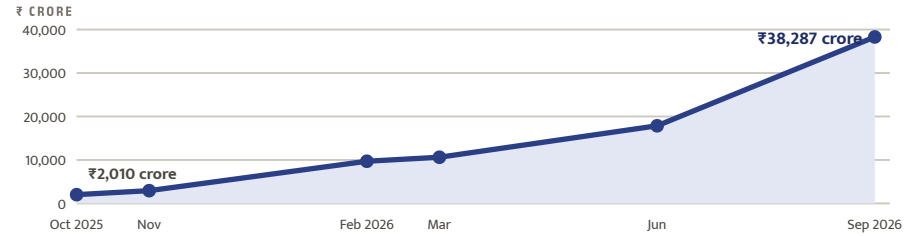
Same trades, three wrappers



Gains made inside a SIF are not taxed along the way, so that money stays invested until you redeem, and you choose when. Rates are in the tax check in entry 04.

A FAST-GROWING CATEGORY

Industry assets, month-end



17 fund houses offered SIFs by September 2026, with over 1.5 lakh investor folios. Source: AMFI data, as reported. Growth in assets says nothing about future returns.

Investments in SIFs are subject to market risks, read all investment strategy related documents carefully. Illustrations show what the rules allow and how tax works. They do not show or promise returns. Ram Investments is an AMFI Registered Mutual Fund Distributor and SIF Distributor (ARN-[___]).

05 NCDs

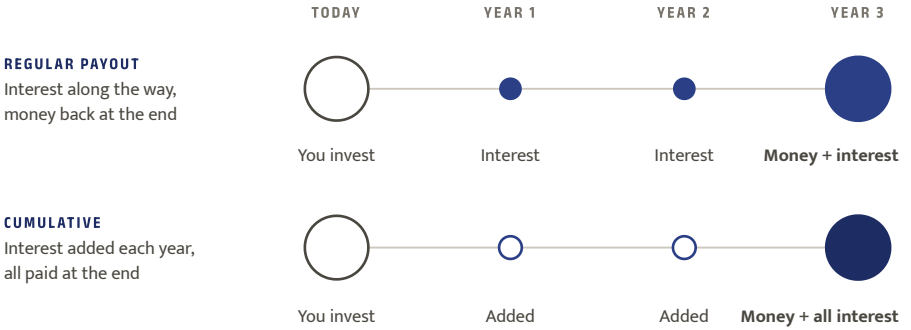
NON-CONVERTIBLE DEBENTURES · REGULATED BY SEBI

An NCD is a loan you give a company for a fixed period. The company pays you interest at a fixed rate and returns your money at maturity. It can never turn into shares, hence "non-convertible".

WHERE YOUR MONEY GOES, AND WHEN IT COMES BACK

FIG. 05

How you are paid. The rate is fixed when you invest and stays the same to maturity.



Regular payouts give you income along the way. Cumulative pays it all at maturity.

IF THE COMPANY FAILS, WHO IS PAID FIRST?

1 Secured lenders including secured NCDs → **2 Unsecured lenders** including unsecured NCDs → **3 Shareholders** paid last, if anything is left

Simplified. What you recover depends on the assets and the legal process.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- Fixed interest, paid monthly, yearly or all at maturity (cumulative).
- Carries a credit rating from an agency such as CRISIL, ICRA, CARE or India Ratings.
- Secured NCDs are backed by the company's assets. Unsecured ones are not, and rank lower if the company fails.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

Bank fixed deposits. Bank deposits are insured up to ₹5 lakh per depositor per bank by DICGC. NCDs are not insured. A higher NCD rate is payment for taking more risk.

AT A GLANCE

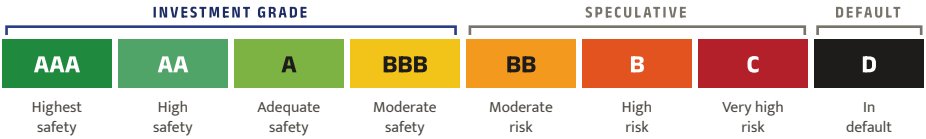
The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	SEBI (issue and listing). Issuers that are NBFCs are also regulated by RBI.
MINIMUM	Usually ₹10,000 in a public issue.
TIME COMMITMENT	The tenure of the series you pick, usually 18 months to 10 years.
MONEY OUT	Interest as chosen, principal at maturity. You can sell earlier on the exchange, but the price may be lower and buyers few.
COSTS	No fee to apply in a public issue. A demat account is needed; brokerage applies if you sell.
TAX IN BRIEF	Interest is taxed at your slab rate. Selling a listed NCD after 12 months: 12.5% on the gain; earlier, your slab rate.



RISK CHECK: THE CREDIT RATING

Read it before the interest rate



A + or – fine-tunes a grade: AA+ is stronger than AA–. CRISIL, ICRA, CARE and India Ratings use similar scales.

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ You want a predictable, regular income.
- ✓ You can hold the NCD until it matures.
- ✓ You accept that your money depends on the company's ability to pay.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ You are chasing the highest rate. High rates usually mean higher risk.
- ✗ You may need the money before maturity.
- ✗ The NCD is unrated, unsecured, or from a company you do not know.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ What is the rating, from which agency, and is the outlook stable?
- ☐ Which series: tenure, payout frequency and effective yield?
- ☐ Is it secured, and what is the asset cover?
- ☐ What happens if I need my money early?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

ISSUER / SERIES .....

RATE % AND PAYOUT .....

AMOUNT ₹ .....

MATURES ON .....

Investments in debt securities are subject to risks including delay and/or default in payment. Read all the offer related documents carefully. Ratings are opinions, not guarantees. Ram Investments [stock broker / online bond platform registration: ___].

06 PMS

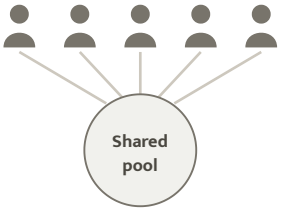
PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT SERVICES · REGULATED BY SEBI

A SEBI-registered portfolio manager runs a portfolio of stocks or bonds for you. Unlike a mutual fund, the securities sit in your own demat account, so you can see every holding and every trade.

WHO OWNS WHAT, AND WHO DECIDES

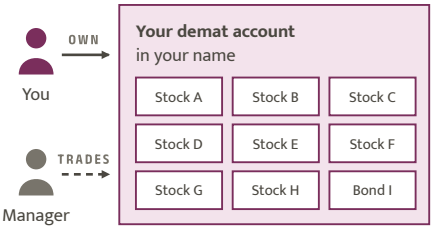
FIG. 06

MUTUAL FUND



You own **units** of a shared pool.

PMS



You own **the shares themselves.**

THREE WAYS TO WORK WITH A MANAGER

MANAGER DECIDES — YOU DECIDE

Discretionary
The manager decides and trades for you. The most common type.

Non-discretionary
The manager suggests, you approve each trade, the manager executes.

Advisory
The manager advises; you decide and place each trade yourself.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- The shares sit in your own demat account, so you see every holding and every trade.
- Every PMS reports returns against a common benchmark, so managers can be compared.
- Upfront fees are not allowed. Fees are fixed, linked to performance above a hurdle, or both.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

Mutual funds. A shared pool. You own units, not shares.

AIFs. A pooled fund with a ₹1 crore minimum that can hold unlisted assets and lock you in for years.

AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	SEBI. The Portfolio Managers Regulations, 2026 apply from 1 April 2027.
MINIMUM	₹50 lakh. PRIM (mutual-fund-only route): ₹25 lakh from 1 April 2027.
TIME COMMITMENT	No lock-in. Exit charges may apply in the early years.
MONEY OUT	Withdraw part or all. You receive cash, or the securities themselves.
COSTS	Management fee and/or performance fee, plus brokerage, custody and GST.
TAX IN BRIEF	Every trade is taxed in your hands, as if you had made it yourself.



RISK CHECK: CONCENTRATION

Fewer stocks, bigger bets

EQUITY MUTUAL FUND · 40–80 STOCKS



PMS · OFTEN 15–30 STOCKS



With 20 equal holdings, each stock is 5% of your money; with 60, each is under 2%.

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ You have ₹50 lakh or more for equities and want a focused approach.
- ✓ You want to see every stock and trade in your own account.
- ✓ You accept that returns can differ widely from the index.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ Low cost matters most to you. Compare fees with mutual funds.
- ✗ You would rather not see many capital-gains entries in your tax return.
- ✗ You are choosing a manager on last year's return alone.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ How has the strategy done against its benchmark over a full market cycle?
- ☐ Is the service discretionary or non-discretionary?
- ☐ What are all the fees: fixed, performance, hurdle, high-water mark, exit?
- ☐ How many stocks will I hold, and of what size?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

MANAGER / STRATEGY

AMOUNT ₹

FEE MODEL

BENCHMARK

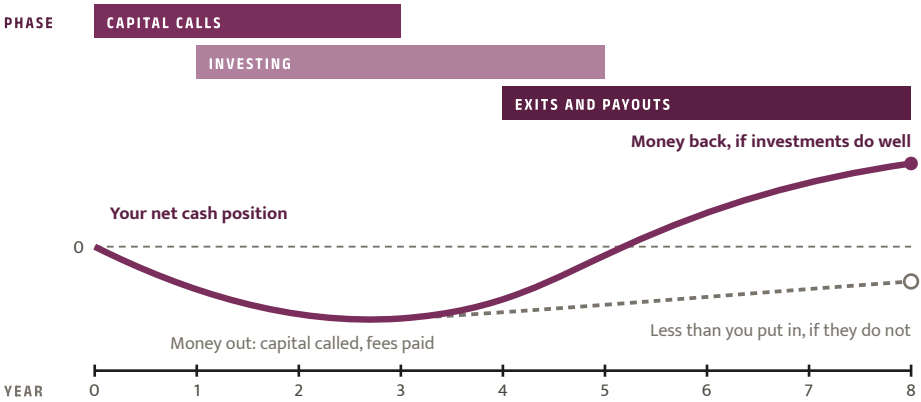
Investments in securities are subject to market risks. Read the disclosure document carefully before investing. Past performance does not guarantee future returns. Ram Investments is an APMI Registered PMS Distributor (APRN-[___]).

07 AIF

ALTERNATIVE INVESTMENT FUNDS · REGULATED BY SEBI

An AIF is a privately pooled fund that reaches where public markets cannot: companies in the years before they list, private credit, real estate and start-ups, as well as specialist strategies in listed markets.

THE LIFE OF A CLOSED-ENDED FUND — FIG. 07



Illustrative. Timelines and outcomes differ from fund to fund.

CATEGORY I

Start-ups, SMEs, infrastructure and social impact

CATEGORY II

Private equity, private credit, real estate. No borrowing to invest.

CATEGORY III

Hedge-fund-style strategies in listed markets; may use leverage.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- Gives you a share of companies in their private years, often a decade or more before they list.
- You commit an amount, and the manager draws it in parts (capital calls) as deals are found.
- Offered only by private placement, to at most 1,000 investors per scheme.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

PMS. Your own account, mostly listed shares, and no lock-in. An AIF pools money and may hold assets that cannot be sold quickly.

AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	SEBI (Alternative Investment Funds Regulations, 2012).
MINIMUM	₹1 crore commitment, drawn in parts as the fund invests.
TIME COMMITMENT	Category I and II: closed-ended, often 4–10 years. Category III: open or closed-ended.
MONEY OUT	Usually as the fund sells investments, towards the end of its life. Early exit is limited or not possible.
COSTS	A management fee plus carried interest, a share of profits above the hurdle.
TAX IN BRIEF	Category I and II are pass-through: income is taxed in your hands. Category III pays tax in the fund; you receive post-tax returns.



COST CHECK: HOW PROFITS ARE SHARED

The distribution waterfall

1 Capital back

All your capital comes back to you first.

2 Hurdle

Then the hurdle: a return set in the fund's terms, if the fund earns it.

3 Catch-up

Then the manager catches up, in some funds only.

4 The rest is split

often 80% to you, 20% to the manager.

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ You have ₹1 crore or more that you will not need for 7 to 10 years.
- ✓ You want a share of the growth that happens before companies list.
- ✓ Your protection and core portfolio are already in place.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ You may need this money before the fund ends.
- ✗ ₹1 crore is a large share of your net worth.
- ✗ You are not prepared for some investments to fail. Results vary widely between funds.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ What does the fund invest in, and how did the manager's earlier funds do?
- ☐ What are the fees, the hurdle and the carry?
- ☐ How much will be called, and how often? What if I miss a call?
- ☐ How long is the fund's life, and can it be extended?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

FUND / CATEGORY .....

COMMITMENT ₹ .....

CALLED SO FAR ₹ .....

FUND ENDS .....

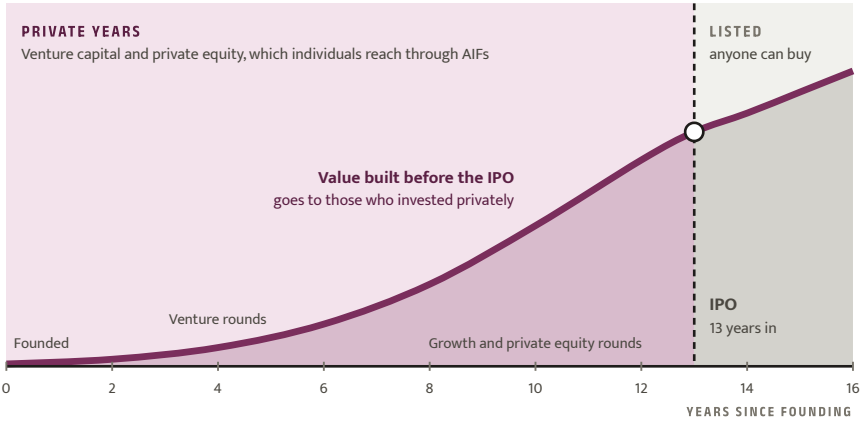
AIFs are offered only by private placement to eligible investors, through the fund's private placement memorandum. This page is investor education. It is not an offer or a solicitation. Ram Investments [AIF distribution arrangement: ___].

PRIVATE MARKETS

Where the early growth happens

Indian companies now raise money privately for a decade or more before they list. By the time most investors can buy at the IPO, much of that early growth has already happened. AIFs are how individual investors can take part earlier.

THE LIFE OF A COMPANY, BEFORE AND AFTER IT LISTS — Illustration



Illustrative path. Many companies never list, and some list below their last private value.

13.3 years

from founding to listing, on average, for Indian tech companies that listed in 2025.

Orios Venture Partners

$36 billion

invested by private equity and venture capital funds in Indian companies in 2025, across about 1,700 deals.

Bain & Company and IVCA

87%

of US companies with over $100 million in revenue are private. Private markets are where much of the economy now sits.

S&P Capital IQ, via Apollo

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

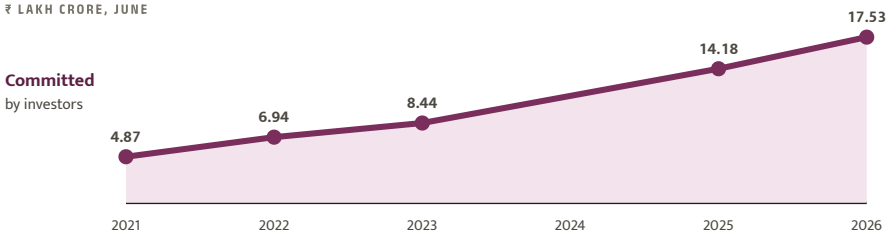
An IPO is often when early investors sell part of their stake to the public. To own a share of a company in its private years, you invest before it lists, through an AIF. That means a long wait, and accepting that some companies never list, or list below their private value.

PRIVATE MARKETS

Taking part in private markets

MONEY COMMITTED TO AIFS

SEBI data, as reported



WHICH AIFS INVEST WHEN

Before a company lists



Category II also covers private credit, which lends to companies, and real estate funds. Many companies never list; funds also exit by selling to other buyers.

CHOOSE THE MANAGER WITH CARE

Results vary widely

Outcomes differ far more from one private-market fund to the next than between funds that invest in listed shares. Ask how long the team has worked together, what happened in its earlier funds, and how it handled difficult years.

IS IT FOR YOU?

Tick what is true

- ☐ ₹1 crore or more that you will not need for 7 to 10 years
- ☐ Protection and a core portfolio already in place
- ☐ Comfortable with no daily price, and with some investments failing
- ☐ Able to meet capital calls on time, for several years

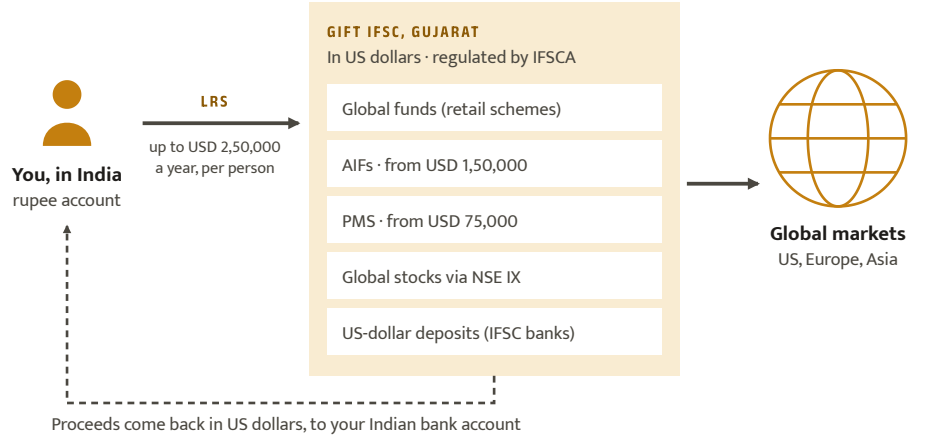
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08 GIFT City

INTERNATIONAL INVESTING VIA GIFT IFSC · REGULATED BY IFSCA

GIFT City in Gujarat is home to India's International Financial Services Centre (IFSC). Resident Indians can invest there in US dollars, within their yearly LRS limit, through entities regulated by IFSCA.

THE ROUTE FROM YOUR BANK ACCOUNT TO THE WORLD — FIG. 08



YOUR LRS LIMIT IS SHARED — USD 2,50,000 PER FINANCIAL YEAR



Example split. Each family member has a separate limit.

HOW TO RECOGNISE IT

- You invest in US dollars. Returns depend on the markets and on the rupee–dollar rate.
- Uses your LRS limit of USD 2,50,000 per person per financial year, shared with travel, education and gifts.
- TCS of 20% applies on investment remittances above ₹10 lakh a year. You can set it off against tax or claim a refund.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

International funds in rupees. Sold in India in INR, but they can stop taking new money when industry overseas limits are reached.

Foreign broker accounts. Your money sits overseas, under a foreign regulator.

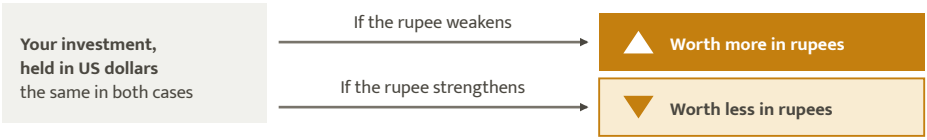
AT A GLANCE

The same six facts for every product

REGULATOR	IFSCA, the regulator for GIFT City. Remittances follow RBI's Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS).
MINIMUM	Depends on the product: retail funds set their own; PMS from USD 75,000; AIFs from USD 1,50,000 (accredited investors excepted).
TIME COMMITMENT	Open-ended funds can be redeemed; AIFs run for a fixed term.
MONEY OUT	Proceeds are paid in US dollars and can be brought back to your Indian bank account.
COSTS	Fund or service fees, plus currency conversion and bank remittance charges.
TAX IN BRIEF	Gains are taxable in India for residents. TCS is not an extra tax: it is adjusted against what you owe.

RISK CHECK: THE CURRENCY EFFECT

Illustration only



Same investment, same day. Only the exchange rate differs, and it can work either way.

SUITS YOU IF

- ✓ Most of your wealth is in India and you want global diversification.
- ✓ You have goals in dollars: education abroad, travel, overseas property.
- ✓ You prefer an Indian-regulated route and Indian time-zone service.

THINK TWICE IF

- ✗ You may need the money soon. Currency swings can hurt in the short term.
- ✗ You have already used most of this year's LRS limit.
- ✗ You have not planned for TCS holding back cash until you file your return.

ASK BEFORE YOU SIGN

Tick when answered

- ☐ What exactly does this product invest in, and where?
- ☐ How much of my LRS limit have I used this financial year?
- ☐ What is the minimum, and what are all costs, including currency conversion?
- ☐ How will my gains be taxed?

MY NOTES

Write your own numbers here

PRODUCT ..... AMOUNT USD .....

LRS USED THIS FY ..... TCS PAID ₹ .....

Investments in GIFT IFSC are subject to market and currency risks, and to RBI's LRS and FEMA rules. Read all scheme related documents carefully. Ram Investments [IFSC distribution registration: ___].

ALL EIGHT, SIDE BY SIDE

Protect and build

Every row continues across both pages. Details and conditions are in each entry.

	01 **Term insurance** page 4	02 **Health insurance** page 6	03 **Mutual funds** page 8	04 **SIF** page 10
IN A LINE	Pays your family a lump sum if something happens to you.	Pays hospital bills up to your sum insured.	A pooled portfolio run by a professional manager.	A mutual fund with tools for every kind of market.
REGULATOR	IRDAI	IRDAI	SEBI	SEBI, under mutual fund rules
MINIMUM	A yearly premium, set by age, health and cover	A yearly premium, set by age, cover and city	**SIPs from ₹100–₹500** a month	**₹10 lakh** per investor, per fund house
TIME COMMITMENT	The policy term, often to age 60–70	One year at a time; renew without a break	None for most funds; ELSS 3 years	No lock-in for most strategies
MONEY OUT	Paid to your family (nominee) on a claim	Cashless at the hospital, or reimbursed	Any business day, at that day's NAV	Equity daily; hybrid at least twice a week
MAIN RISK TO WATCH	Too little cover; incomplete disclosure	Room-rent caps, co-pays, waiting periods	Market falls. See the riskometer	Strategy and derivatives. See the risk band
TAX IN BRIEF	Payout tax-free. Premium deductible in the old regime	Premium deductible in the old regime	Equity: 12.5% on gains above ₹1.25 lakh. Debt: slab rate	Same as mutual funds. No tax inside the fund
BEST FOR	Anyone whose family depends on their income	Every family, alongside any employer cover	Most investors, as the core of a portfolio	A whole portfolio or part of one, from ₹10 lakh

ALL EIGHT, SIDE BY SIDE

Build, specialise and globalise

Minimums are the regulator's floors. A provider may ask for more.

	05 NCDs page 14	06 PMS page 16	07 AIF page 18	08 GIFT City page 22
IN A LINE	A fixed-rate loan to a company, for a fixed term.	A manager runs a portfolio in your own demat account.	A private pooled fund for unlisted companies and assets.	Global investing in US dollars, from India.
REGULATOR	SEBI; RBI for NBFC issuers	SEBI	SEBI	IFSCA; RBI's LRS
MINIMUM	**Usually ₹10,000** in a public issue	**₹50 lakh**; PRIM route ₹25 lakh from April 2027	**₹1 crore** commitment	Varies: PMS USD 75,000; AIFs USD 1,50,000
TIME COMMITMENT	18 months to 10 years	No lock-in; early exit charges may apply	Often 4–10 years; closed-ended	Depends on the product
MONEY OUT	At maturity, or sell on the exchange	Withdraw cash or securities	As investments are sold, near the end	In US dollars, back to your Indian bank
MAIN RISK TO WATCH	The company failing to pay. See the rating	Concentration and the manager's skill	Money locked in; the manager's skill	Currency swings and overseas markets
TAX IN BRIEF	Interest at your slab rate	Each trade taxed in your hands	Cat I and II: in your hands. Cat III: in the fund	Taxable in India; TCS is adjustable
BEST FOR	Income seekers who can hold to maturity	Equity investors wanting a focused portfolio	Large, patient portfolios wanting pre-IPO access	Investors who want global, dollar exposure

Words to know

Terms used in this guide, in plain words.

Accredited investor. Certified as meeting income or wealth tests; some products then have lower minimums.

AMC. Asset management company: the firm that runs a mutual fund's schemes.

Arbitrage. Buying a share and selling its future at the same time, to capture the small price gap.

Asset cover. The value of assets backing a secured NCD, compared with what is owed.

Capital call. A request for part of the money you committed to an AIF. Also called a drawdown.

Carried interest. The AIF manager's share of profits above the hurdle.

Cashless claim. The insurer pays a network hospital directly, so you do not pay up front.

Co-payment. The share of each health claim you pay yourself.

Credit rating. An agency's opinion of how likely a borrower is to pay on time, from AAA to D.

Deductible. The part of a year's bills that a top-up policy does not pay.

Derivatives. Futures and options: contracts whose value moves with a share or an index.

Exit load. A charge for selling mutual fund units before a set period.

Exposure. How much of a fund moves with the market. A SIF can take it below zero.

Free look. 30 days to return a new insurance policy if it does not suit you.

Hedge. A position that rises when your holdings fall, to cushion the loss.

High-water mark. A performance fee is paid only on gains above the portfolio's previous peak.

Hurdle rate. The return investors must receive before the manager shares in profits.

IFSCA. International Financial Services Centres Authority, the regulator in GIFT City.

Long-short. Owning shares expected to rise, and betting against those expected to fall.

LRS. Liberalised Remittance Scheme: up to USD 2,50,000 abroad per person, per financial year.

Moratorium. After 5 continuous years of health cover, a claim cannot be refused for non-disclosure, except fraud.

NAV. Net asset value: the price of one mutual fund unit, worked out every business day.

Nominee. The person you name to receive the money from a policy or investment in your absence.

Pass-through. Income taxed in your hands, not in the fund, as for AIF Category I and II.

Portability. Moving a health policy to another insurer while keeping waiting-period credit.

Private markets. Companies and assets not listed on a stock exchange.

Rider. An add-on to an insurance policy, such as cover for critical illness or accidents.

Risk band. The five-level risk label shown for every SIF strategy.

Riskometer. SEBI's six-level risk label shown on every mutual fund scheme.

SIP. Systematic investment plan: a fixed amount invested at regular intervals.

Sum assured, sum insured. What a life policy pays on a claim; the most a health policy pays in a year.

TCS. Tax collected at source by your bank on large overseas remittances, adjusted against your tax.

TER. Total expense ratio: a fund's yearly running costs, taken from the NAV.

Venture capital. Money for young, fast-growing private companies, years before they list.

Waiting period. Time after buying health cover before some conditions are covered.

Your 2027 money check-up

Fifteen minutes each quarter. Tick each line once it is done.

CHECK	JAN–MAR	APR–JUN	JUL–SEP	OCT–DEC
PROTECT				
Term cover still matches my family's needs	☐	☐	☐	☐
Health policy renewed; new family members added	☐	☐	☐	☐
Nominees up to date on every policy and investment	☐	☐	☐	☐
BUILD				
SIPs running as planned	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mutual fund and SIF mix checked against my plan	☐	☐	☐	☐
NCD interest received; maturities noted	☐	☐	☐	☐
SPECIALISE				
PMS and AIF statements read against benchmarks	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cash set aside for upcoming AIF capital calls	☐	☐	☐	☐
GLOBALISE				
LRS used this financial year noted	☐	☐	☐	☐
TCS credit claimed in my tax return	☐	☐	☐	☐
EVERY YEAR				
Emergency fund covers about six months	☐	☐	☐	☐
KYC, address and bank details up to date	☐	☐	☐	☐
Will written or reviewed	☐	☐	☐	☐

OUR REVIEW MEETINGS Dates we agree together

Q1 ..... Q2 ..... Q3 ..... Q4 .....

YOUR RELATIONSHIP MANAGER ..... PHONE .....

Important information

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This section is investor education. It is not an offer, solicitation or recommendation to buy or sell any product, and it is not investment, tax or legal advice. Facts are as of October 2026 and can change. Read the offer documents of any product before investing, and speak to your adviser or tax consultant about your own situation.

Ram Investments

AMFI Registered Mutual Fund Distributor and SIF Distributor (SIFD) · ARN-[___]

APMI Registered PMS Distributor · APRN-[___]

Insurance: [IRDAI registration type and number]

NCDs: [stock broker / online bond platform registration] · AIF and GIFT IFSC: [distribution arrangements]

[Address] · [Phone] · [Email] · [Website]

HOW WE ARE PAID

We receive commission from the providers of the products we distribute. Details of the commission we earn on your investments are available on request.

STANDARD WARNINGS

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Investments in SIFs are subject to market risks, read all investment strategy related documents carefully.

Investments in debt securities are subject to risks including delay and/or default in payment. Read all the offer related documents carefully.

Insurance: for details on risk factors, terms and conditions, read the sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale.

PMS: investments in securities are subject to market risks; read the disclosure document carefully. AIFs are offered only by private placement to eligible investors.

IF YOU HAVE A COMPLAINT

Contact us first at [email]. If it is not resolved: for securities products, SEBI SCORES (scores.sebi.gov.in) and the SMART ODR portal (smartodr.in); for insurance, IRDAI Bima Bharosa (bimabharosa.irdai.gov.in) and the Insurance Ombudsman; for GIFT IFSC products, IFSCA.

SOURCES

SEBI, AMFI, APMI, IRDAI, IFSCA, RBI, the Income-tax Act, 2025, and the industry reports named on each page. This guide does not show or project the returns of any product. Past performance does not guarantee future returns.